1. Green flag or red flag: hiring a service business

- Has hundreds of five-star reviews
- The owner answers your call personally
- Quotes significantly less than everyone else
- Shows up exactly when promised
- Has been in business for 20 years
- Gives you a detailed written estimate

2. Overrated or underrated: growing a brokerage

- Stop taking small assignments
- Hiring brokers from competing firms
- Getting exclusive listings
- Building a personal brand
- Expanding into another market
- Adding property management

3. Overrated or underrated: what clients pay for

- Years of experience
- Fast responses
- A recognizable company name
- Access to the owner
- Specialized knowledge
- Being available outside business hours

4. Green flag or red flag: a salesperson

- Tells you that you don't need the most expensive option
- Says they can beat any competitor's price
- Asks more questions than they answer
- Admits a competitor might be a better fit
- Follows up after you've said "not right now"
- Won't give you a price until they understand what you need

5. Overrated or underrated: becoming a top broker

- Knowing wealthy people
- Having a finance degree
- Being naturally outgoing
- Knowing every property in your market
- Working under a top producer
- Being a tough negotiator

6. Raise your price or improve your service first?

- You're booked out several weeks
- You win almost every proposal you send
- Customers keep referring their friends
- Your competitors charge substantially more
- You're busy but barely making money
- You've improved your service but kept the same pricing

7. Overrated or underrated: business advice people repeat

- "The customer is always right"
- "Hire slow, fire fast"
- "Never work with friends"
- "You have to spend money to make money"
- "Charge what you're worth"
- "Work on the business, not in the business"

8. Green flag or red flag: a company's sales process

- Requires a discovery call before sending a proposal
- Sends pricing without ever speaking to you
- Lets you speak directly with the person doing the work
- Offers a discount if you sign today
- Asks why you're leaving your current provider
- Explains what they won't be able to do for you

9. Overrated or underrated: running a brokerage

- Weekly sales meetings
- Tracking how many calls brokers make
- Requiring everyone to use the same CRM
- Having dedicated marketing staff
- Letting brokers set their own schedules
- Hiring experienced brokers instead of training beginners

10. Green flag or red flag: someone wants to join your brokerage

- Has a license but has never worked in sales
- Asks about training before asking about commission splits
- Wants to work across every property type
- Has researched your listings before the interview
- Wants to bring a friend onto the team
- Asks how long they should expect to go without earning a commission